



Semantics and Logic Honors

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADES 9–12 · ONE SEMESTER ·
½ CREDIT · HONORS ELECTIVE

~4¼ hrs per week · 50 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. This page is drawn from the official course descriptions rather than a built Optima course, so the specific texts, arguments, and activities scholars study will be set by the teacher and may vary between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

Semantics and Logic Honors develops a scholar's ability to think clearly and argue rigorously. Students study the principles of logic and semantics — learning how language works, what makes an argument valid, and where reasoning goes wrong — through careful analysis of complex texts and arguments. By learning to recognize logical fallacies, evaluate evidence, and construct sound arguments, scholars develop precision in thinking and the ability to understand what others are actually saying. Using VR and AI-assisted tools, they analyze arguments and apply logical principles to contemporary debates. As an honors course, the work is more abstract and demanding throughout. The course builds intellectual virtue: learning to think carefully, argue fairly, and distinguish truth from sophistry.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 The Principles of Logic (foundation)

Valid and invalid arguments, inductive and deductive reasoning, and what makes reasoning sound.

3 Spotting Fallacies (strand)

Recognizing logical fallacies and weighing evidence and claims in complex, high-level texts.

5 Constructing Sound Arguments (strand)

Writing and presenting arguments with valid reasoning and credible evidence — distinguishing truth from sophistry.

2 Semantics: How Language Works (strand)

Meaning, connotation and denotation, etymology, and the power and impact of language across literary periods.

4 Rhetoric and Argument (strand)

Rhetorical appeals and devices, analyzing classical speeches and essays, and comparing competing arguments on the same topic.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Close reading and analysis of complex texts and arguments most days.
- Logic practice: identifying reasoning, testing validity, and naming fallacies.
- Argument analysis with VR and AI-assisted tools applied to contemporary debates.
- Evidence-based writing and discussion that build and defend sound arguments.

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes / week

≈ 50 minutes a day, Monday–Friday, for one semester

- Reading, logic work, and writing fill most of the scheduled time.
- Extended argument and research tasks may run longer.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.
- A notebook for argument maps, vocabulary, and analysis notes.
- Microsoft 365 and OneDrive (provided to every scholar) for writing.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, when offered live; for 2026–27 Semantics and Logic Honors is listed as an On-Demand course.